

Claude's Comments — Volume 2 Translation Sessions

All of my messages to you in this chat, verbatim, recovered from the session transcript (2 Oct – 8 Oct 2026). Part A holds the main reports and answers; Part B holds the short in-progress status lines. Only the closing remark of the previous turn ("Diacritics render correctly...") is omitted, as it is tool-chatter.

Part A — Reports and answers

Message 9 — 2026-10-02 11:44

I translated printed pages 31–51 (21 pages) into `Rigveda_Samhita_Vol2_English_Translation.md`, reading each page from its rendered image, and pushed to `claude/hopeful-turing-9r66zc`. The work stops at page 51, mid-sentence in the grammar for Rik 3.7. The progress note at the end of the file says where to resume (page 52, PDF page 67).

What the pages cover

- **Rik 3.4:** Sayana's commentary and the Kannada apparatus, including the long list of derivations of the name "Indra" (pp. 31–38).
- **Rik 3.5:** the "-jūta" compounds and word-meanings (pp. 38–42).
- **Rik 3.6:** closes the fifth varga at p. 46.
- **Rik 3.7:** the first verse of the Vaiśvadeva group, with the discussion of the Viśvedevas (who the Viśvedevas are), through p. 51.
- **Method:** dense grammar pages are summarised, as convention 5 allows, with every cited sūtra kept in all three layers. I also updated `CLAUDE.md` with the new position and a few conventions.

Things you should know

- **Script:** in this stretch the Sanskrit is printed in Kannada script, not Devanagari. I converted it letter by letter and bracketed anything garbled with [?].
- **Numbers:** the small Kannada digits in reference numbers and counts are the weakest part. Pages 37, 40, 41, 44, 46, 50 and 51 are best-effort and marked [?]. The vāghat list on p. 41 and the Viśvedeva counts on p. 50 especially need a re-check.
- **Accent-marks:** from Rik 3.5 onward I did not reproduce the accent-marks on the Saṃhitā/Pada texts, because I could not convert the Kannada notation reliably. Riks 3.1–3.4 earlier in the file do carry accents, and the inconsistency is noted in the text.
- **Corrections to my own earlier text in this batch** (disclosed in the file):
 - p. 31 now reads "prāṇaiḥ", corrected from the blurred first reading.
 - p. 32 now reads "parihartā" and "voto guṇavacanāt".
 - p. 39 now attributes "nab-ṣayasyānisantasya" to the Phiṭ-sūtras. I had first cited Pāṇini 6-1-223 from memory.
 - The odd-page header descriptions are now "Aṣṭaka 1, Adhyāya 1, Varga N".
- **Not touched, older text:** p. 29 has a stray Cyrillic string ("ародит") in a citation. It is flagged in the progress note for a later cleanup.

Message 16 — 2026-10-02 14:12

I translated printed pages 52–85, which closes Sūkta 3 (all twelve Riks), and pushed it to `claude/hopeful-turing-9r66zc`. The file and `CLAUDE.md` now say the next task is Sūkta 4, starting at printed page 86 (PDF page 101).

What the pages cover

- **Rik 3.7 - 3.9:** the rest of Rik 3.7's grammar, then Riks 3.8 and 3.9, including the story of Agni hiding in the waters and its Taittirīya Saṃhitā version.
- **Rik 3.10:** a very long discussion of Sarasvatī as river and as goddess (pp. 64–80), covering her ṛṣis, her geography and the ten Āprī-sūktas.
- **Riks 3.11 - 3.12:** both verses in full, ending with "Here the third sūkta is complete" on p. 85.

What you need to check

- **Reference numbers:** the small Kannada numerals for Ṛg-vedic references and counts are the weakest part. On pp. 77 and 78 I left several out rather than guess. These need a pass against the page images: pp. 71–73, 75–78.
- **Garbled print:** I did not reconstruct the garbled stretches on pp. 69, 73, 79, 80 and 85. They are marked [?], and in a few places I give only an outline of the sense.
- **Source inconsistencies:** two I recorded rather than resolved. Viśvāmitra is fifth in descent from Atri on p. 70 and seventh on p. 71. The Uṇādi-sūtra number for "vahi-śri-..." reads differently on pp. 58 and 59.
- **Accents:** Saṃhitā and Pada accent-marks are still not reproduced from Rik 3.5 onward, so Riks 3.1–3.4 are inconsistent with the rest.
- **Older text:** the stray Cyrillic string on p. 29 is still there for a later cleanup.
- **Corrections in place:** I corrected "ehi mā yāsīḥ" on p. 58 and the closing marks on p. 83 after rereading them on later pages, and noted each in the text.

The progress note at the end of the file lists all of this, and `CLAUDE.md` has the updated position.

Message 17 — 2026-10-02 14:19

The updated file is on the `claude/hopeful-turing-9r66zc` branch, not on `main`, which is probably why you're not seeing it. The branch holds the Volume 2 translation through printed page 85 (origin/main has none of these pages), and the push succeeded (latest commit `a335f2e`).

I haven't merged anything into `main`, because I was told to push only to that branch. To see the update, open the file on the branch:

`Rigveda_Samhita_Vol2_English_Translation.md` on `claude/hopeful-turing-9r66zc`

If you'd rather have it on `main`, tell me and I'll open a pull request. I won't open one unless you ask.

While checking, I found two leftover progress lines I had written by mistake and removed them. One was a duplicate at the very end of the file, and the other was in the middle, after page 38. The file now ends with the correct progress note: through page 85, with Sūkta 4 next at printed page 86.

Three older progress notes from earlier sessions are still in the file, at roughly lines 170, 385 and 501. I left them alone.

Message 23 — 2026-10-02 14:37

Sūkta 4 is finished: I translated printed pages 86–135 (all ten Riks, 4.1–4.10) and pushed to `claude/hopeful-turing-9r66zc` (latest commit `dbe84aa`). The progress note at the end of the file and `CLAUDE.md` now say the next task is Sūkta 5 at printed page 136 (PDF page 151). I haven't merged anything into main.

The pages cover the sūkta's opening note and heading, then Riks 4.1–4.10 one after another. The notable inserts are the discussion of Indra as the rain-bringer who slays Vṛtra (the cloud, in Yāska's reading) on pp. 123–124, and the note on the "kampa" accent-sign on pp. 131–134. The closing note, "this fourth sūkta is complete," is on p. 135.

Things to know:

- **Grammar pages summarised:** pp. 92–93, 98–99, 106–107, 119–120, 125 and 133–135 are dense argument about accent and sandhi that doesn't change the sense of the verses. I summarised them in outline and kept every sūtra they name in all three layers, as convention 5 allows. A few crowded stretches I left out and said so in the text.
- **Reference numbers:** the small Kannada digits remain the weakest part, so many Ṛg-vedic, Nirukta, Uṇādi and Pāṇini numbers are marked [?]. The longer lists need re-checking against the page images (pp. 96, 113, 123, 127–128).
- **Varga numbers:** the page headers and the closing notes give numbers that don't agree (p. 103 and p. 111 say "seventh", p. 135 reads "eighth"). I recorded them as read and didn't pick one.
- **Source oddities left as printed:**

- "uta" is called first-syllable acute on p. 112 but end-acute on p. 114.

- The "kampa" verse on p. 132 has a last line I couldn't read, so I gave no translation of it.

- **Accents:** the Saṃhitā and Pada accent-marks are still not reproduced from Rik 3.5 onward.
- **Cleanup:** my append helper tacked a stray "Progress" line onto the file end again, and I removed it. Three older progress notes from earlier sessions (around lines 170, 385 and 501) are still in the file, along with the stray Cyrillic string on p. 29.

Message 24 — 2026-10-02 15:06

Sūkta 5 is finished. I translated printed pages 136–201 (all ten Riks, 5.1–5.10) and pushed to `claude/hopeful-turing-9r66zc` (latest commit `edb4b7f`). The progress note and `CLAUDE.md` now say the next task is Sūkta 6, "yuñjanti bradhnām", at printed page 202 (PDF page 217). Nothing is merged to main.

- **Introduction (pp. 136–151):**

- It covers the Soma-sacrifices, the stoma, and the thirty viṣṭutis of the nine stomas as paryāya tables.

- It also covers the āvāpa numbers and the Mahāvratā and extended-sacrifice table.

- I summed each viṣṭuti's paryāya counts against its stoma's number as a check.

- One does not add up: the "pratyaavarohiṇī" viṣṭuti of the trayastriṃśa stoma on p. 147 reads as 32, not 33. I left the digits as read and flagged it.

- **Riks 5.1-5.10:** the Bhāṣya, Pada-meanings, Bhāvārtha and the source's own English for each. The long grammar pages are summarised in outline with the sūtras kept, as before. Two notable inserts:

- The list of verses on "dadhyāśiraḥ" and the other milk/barley admixtures (pp. 172-174).
- Skandasvāmī's different reading of Rik 5.9 (p. 193).

- **Corrections to my own earlier text, noted in the file:**

- I had written the stoma term as "vispṛti"; the print reads "viṣṭuti", so I corrected pp. 136-139.
- The Āśvalāyana āvāpa sūtra on p. 149 was misread and is fixed.

- **Reference numbers:** the Ṛg-vedic and Nirukta references remain weak, so most are marked [?]. For the last verse on p. 188 ("śaṃ na indrāgnī...") I gave "6-73-1" from the wording, not from the print, and the text says so.
- **Varga numbers:** the plain closing note on p. 201 says the tenth varga ends there. That suggests my earlier "seventh/eighth" varga notes (pp. 103, 111, 135) were misread small numerals. I left them as written and flagged them for a re-check.
- **Cleanup still open:** the stray Cyrillic string on p. 29 and the older progress notes mid-file (lines ~170, 385, 501 and the one for page 135) are still in the file.

Message 27 — 2026-10-02 15:29

Sūkta 6 is finished and pushed to claude/hopeful-turing-9r66zc. It covers printed pages 202-257, with all ten Riks (6.1-6.10) in the three-layer format. The grammar pages are summarized in outline, with every sūtra I could read kept in three layers.

- **Last pages:** Rik 6.8 (pp. 244-245) was completed from the pages I had viewed but not yet written. Rik 6.9 (pp. 245-251) and Rik 6.10 (pp. 251-257) follow. The dense accent-precedence argument on pp. 251-256 is outline only.
- **Corrections to my own drafts:** Rik 6.10 originally contained Pāṇini/Uṇādi details I had filled in from memory. I re-read p. 252 at higher zoom and rewrote that block from the actual print. I also changed the *cavā-yoge prathamā* reference to Pāṇini 8-1-59 (the standard number; the print's numeral is small).
- **Open flags:**

- **Varga count:** the closing note on p. 257 reads "eighth varga". The p. 201 note was read "tenth", and the small page-header numerals disagree again. I recorded the discrepancy and did not reconcile it.

- **Uncertain readings:** reference numerals that were not clear are marked [?] throughout Sūkta 6. A few clipped word-starts in Riks 6.5-6.7 (pp. 227, 230, 236) and the garbled Skandasvāmī passages (pp. 206-207) are flagged as before.

- **Not yet cleaned:** the older progress notes inside the file and the stray Cyrillic string on p. 29.

- **Next:** Sūkta 7 starts in the lower half of printed p. 257 (PDF page 272), and I have not translated it. The progress note at the end of the file and the "Current position" section of CLAUDE.md both say so.

No PR has been opened.

Message 28 — 2026-10-02 15:41

Yes. The cost here comes mostly from reading page images, plus the long conversation that gets re-read on every turn. These changes should help, roughly in order of impact:

1. **Start a fresh session for each sūкта.** The context grows with every page image, and all of it is re-sent on each turn. Sūкта 6 ran long enough to be compacted once. CLAUDE.md and the progress note already carry the position, so a new session per sūкта loses nothing.
1. **Switch to a cheaper model for the reading and transcription.** Use /model to pick a smaller model such as Sonnet or Haiku, and keep a larger one for review. The risk is that accuracy on Kannada-script Sanskrit may drop, so I'd test it on one sūкта and compare against a page you already trust.
1. **Skip the zoomed re-reads unless a page needs them.** I rendered pages at 150 dpi, then often re-rendered crops at 230–260 dpi. That is roughly double the image reads. Crop only the dense bhāṣya or numeral blocks, and don't zoom on grammar pages.
1. **Relax the grammar pages in CLAUDE.md.** These pages are the most expensive and the least valuable, because they are scholastic accent arguments. I could change convention 5 to say that Vyākaraṇa-prakriyā pages get a two-to-three line note: the word list and the sūtra names, with no zooming and no detailed outline. Sūкта 6 had about 15 such pages, and I read several of them twice.
1. **Don't view the same page twice.** Several times I viewed a page and then wrote it in a later turn. Writing right after viewing avoids paying for the image twice.
1. **Batch the edits.** Use fewer, larger appends per batch rather than one write per page or two.

If you tell me which of these you want, I can make the CLAUDE.md edits for 4 and 5 now and leave the model choice to you. Starting a fresh session for Sūкта 7 is the free change.

Message 29 — 2026-10-02 15:44

I've added a "Cost-saving rules" section to CLAUDE.md and pushed it (commit 0b26250 on claude/hopeful-turing-9r66zc). I did not run any test of the new rules.

What the new section says:

- **Sessions:** use one session per sūкта.
- **Viewing:** view each page once and write it immediately, never re-viewing a page already written.
- **Zooming:** render at 150 dpi, and zoom only for the Rik texts, the Sāyaṇa-bhāṣya and numeral tables or citations. Never zoom on grammar pages.
- **Grammar pages:** these get a 2–4 line note naming the words and sūtras. Sūtras are given in three layers only where legible at 150 dpi, and illegible numerals are left as [?]. Everything else keeps full treatment.
- **Appending:** write a whole Rik, or a run of 4–6 pages, in one call.
- **Model:** use a cheaper model for transcription if you pick one, and flag doubtful readings with [?].

I also added a pointer from convention 5 to this section. The older instruction to view the page image before writing is unchanged.

What you do, in order:

1. **Start a new session** on this repo and branch `claude/hopeful-turing-9r66zc`. That fresh start is what drops the stale context.
2. **Pick the model:** type `/model` and choose a cheaper one (Sonnet or Haiku) for the first test. I'd start with Sonnet.
3. **Give the first prompt:** "Follow CLAUDE.md and translate Sūkta 7 from printed page 257. Stop at the end of the sūkta and write the progress note."
4. **Check Sūkta 7's opening pages yourself.** Look at the Rik texts, the Kannada-to-Devanagari conversion and the [?] flags. If the cheaper model's accuracy drops, switch back with `/model` and tell me which pages were weak.
5. **Repeat for Sūkta 8** in another new session. Keep the same model if the quality held.

Tell me if Sūkta 7 comes out worse than Sūkta 6, and I'll adjust the rules.

Message 30 — 2026-10-02 15:45

It depends on where you're running this session. You're following it in the Claude app, so I'm going from how that interface usually works. I can't see your screen, so check against what you actually have.

- **Claude app / `claude.ai/code` (web or mobile):** Type `/model` in the message box where you write to me. Pick it from the list that appears. If you don't see a `/` command menu, look for a model name near the message box or in the new-session dialog. You can choose the model when you start the new session.
- **Terminal (Claude Code CLI):** Type `/model` at the prompt and press Enter. A menu lets you choose.
- **Desktop app or IDE extension:** Typing `/model` in the chat input works the same way, and there is usually also a model selector next to the input.

In all of these, the choice applies to the current session. For the plan, start the new session first, then pick the model before sending the first translation prompt.

If you don't see any model option in your app, tell me what you see near the message box and I'll point you to the right spot.

Message 32 — 2026-10-08 02:56

I've put my comments into `Claude_comments.pdf` (2 pages) and sent it to you. It's also in the repo with a Markdown copy, `Claude_comments.md`, and both are pushed to `claude/hopeful-turing-9r66zc`.

- **What it contains:** my chat remarks only. They are grouped as:
 - the Sūkta 6 summary;
 - corrections to my own drafts;
 - open flags;
 - the cost-reduction advice;

- what I changed in CLAUDE.md;

- your step-by-step plan;

- where to find /model.

- **Limit:** I can only see the recent part of this conversation. Earlier remarks survive as a summary, so the file condenses them and does not quote them.
- **In-file notes not included:** the notes I wrote inside the translation itself (the [?] flags, reading notes and discrepancy remarks in Rigveda_Samhita_Vol2_English_Translation.md) are not in this file. I took "comments made in this chat" to mean chat messages. If you meant those too, I can collect them from the translation into a second section.
- **Rendering check:** I checked the PDF text and the Sanskrit diacritics (ū, ṣ, ṁ and so on) rendered correctly.

Part B — Status lines

- **1** (2026-10-02 11:24) Checking the format used for earlier Bhashya pages, then I'll start transcribing page 31.
- **2** (2026-10-02 11:28) Status: pages 31–34 are appended. I'm now on page 35, which has R̥gveda verse citations that need a close read.
- **3** (2026-10-02 11:30) Status: pages 31–37 are appended. Page 38 closes Rik 4's grammar and prints the Saṃhitā text of Rik 5, so I'm zooming in to read its accent marks.
- **4** (2026-10-02 11:34) Status: pages 31–40 are appended. On page 41 I'm zooming in on the verse citations and the reference-number list.
- **5** (2026-10-02 11:37) Status: pages 31–43 are appended. I'm now on page 44, zooming in on its reference-number lists.
- **6** (2026-10-02 11:39) Status: pages 31–46 are appended. Page 47 is a very dense Bhāṣya page, so I'm reading it in zoomed slices.
- **7** (2026-10-02 11:42) Status: pages 31–49 are appended. Page 50 has several counts and R̥g-vedic reference-numbers, so I'm reading those in a zoomed view.
- **8** (2026-10-02 11:43) Status: the translation through page 51 is written and the progress note is in place. Next I'm updating CLAUDE.md with the new position and conventions, then committing and pushing.
- **10** (2026-10-02 13:58) Status: Rik 3.7 is finished through page 54 and Rik 3.8 has begun. I'm zooming in on page 55's Bhāṣya.
- **11** (2026-10-02 14:00) Status: Rik 3.9 has started and I'm on pages 59–60. I'm zooming in on the Bhāṣya and on the long R̥gveda 10.51 citation.
- **12** (2026-10-02 14:03) Status: pages 31–64 are appended and I'm now on pages 65–66 (Rik 3.10's grammar and the Sarasvatī ṛca notes). First I'm zooming in on the Bhāṣya's Sanskrit.
- **13** (2026-10-02 14:06) Status: pages 31–68 are appended. I'm on pages 69–70, and I'm zooming in on the Sanskrit quotation inside the fourth Sarasvatī explanation.
- **14** (2026-10-02 14:08) Status: pages 31–72 are appended. I'm on pages 73–74, which carry the Āprī-sūkta table.
- **15** (2026-10-02 14:11) Page 83 has the Saṃhitā text and a dense Bhāṣya, so I'm zooming in before transcribing.

- **18** (2026-10-02 14:23) Status: Sūkta 4 is open and Rik 4.1 is done through page 89. I'm now zooming into the verse citations on pages 90–91.
- **19** (2026-10-02 14:26) Status: Riks 4.1–4.3 are mostly in. I'm now writing pages 101–103, which cover Rik 4.3's grammar and special topics.
- **20** (2026-10-02 14:29) Status: Riks 4.1–4.5 are written through page 109. I'm now on pages 110–111, which carry the last notes on Rik 4.5, the Rik 4.6 text, and the end of the seventh varga.
- **21** (2026-10-02 14:30) Status: Riks 4.1–4.6 are in through page 115. Rik 4.7 begins on page 116, so I'm zooming in on its Saṃhitā text and Bhāṣya.
- **22** (2026-10-02 14:32) Status: Riks 4.1–4.8 are done through page 122. Pages 123–124 have the Nirukta quotation on Vṛtra, so I'm zooming in on it.
- **25** (2026-10-02 15:23) Writing the rest of Rik 6.8 into the file; now reading the pages for Rik 6.9.
- **26** (2026-10-02 15:25) Rik 6.9 grammar through p.249 is written; now reading pp.250–251 (PDF 265–266).